KALE REALTY

NEARLY 1 IN 4 HOMES STILL SELL ABOVE ASKING.

That's not the market the price-cut headlines describe.

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THE AVERAGE HOME IS SELLING FOR 98.4 PERCENT OF ITS ASKING PRICE, AND THAT NUMBER WENT UP, NOT DOWN, THIS MONTH.

A slower market and a market that stopped rewarding a sharp price are two different things.

SUPPLY IS LOOSENING. PRICING SKILL IS STILL THE DECIDING FACTOR.

Redfin's own numbers, four weeks ending October 18: months of supply sits at 4.4, inside what Redfin calls a balanced market, not a flood. And in that same market, 23.3 percent of homes sold above list price, up from 23.1 percent, with the average sale-to-list ratio climbing to 98.4 percent, up from 98.3 percent. A market that's cooling overall still has a real pool of buyers competing for the listings that are priced right. The agents reading the whole market correctly are the ones winning that pool, not the ones defaulting every listing to a discount.

WHAT THAT MEANS FOR YOUR NEXT LISTING:

1 **Pull the sale-to-list ratio for your own zip code before you recommend a price.**
The national number is 98.4 percent. Your market may run higher or lower.

2 **Don't default to a price cut on a new listing.**
Check which comparable homes sold above ask in the last 30 days first.

3 **Price for the buyers still competing, not the ones who already walked.**
Almost a quarter of sellers are proof there's still a real bidding pool out there.

4 **Make sure the win lands with you.**
A price that beats asking only pays off fully when your own commission isn't the next thing that gets cut.

THE TAKEAWAY

PRICING SKILL STILL WINS DEALS RIGHT NOW.

Make sure it still pays you what it's worth.

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